

Incident Response SOP

Syed Motors · Document Code: SOP-07 · Type: sop · Department: IT

Purpose

Steps to detect, contain, eradicate and recover from cybersecurity incidents affecting the branch DMS and email.

Effective from the first working day of the current calendar year. Reviewed annually by the document owner and revised as necessary. Version 1.0.

1. Detection

Incidents are detected via alerts from the endpoint agent, email gateway, user reports, or unusual DMS activity. The IT Security Officer is the single point of accountability.

The detection stage provides the entry point into the incident response process. An incident may be identified by automated security alerts or by people observing and reporting unusual activity.

The IT Security Officer has single-point accountability for the incident response process described in this SOP.

2. Containment

On confirmed detection, the affected workstation is disconnected from the network, credentials are reset, and DMS access for the affected user is revoked pending investigation.

These containment actions address the affected workstation, associated credentials, and DMS access. They are applied after detection has been confirmed and remain connected to the investigation process.

3. Eradication and Recovery

The workstation is re-imaged. Backups are restored where data loss occurred. A root-cause analysis document is written within seven days.

4. Communication

For breaches affecting customer data, HR notifies the customer and the branch manager within 72 hours. Public communication, if any, is handled by the marketing manager on branch-manager authority only.

1. Detection - Identifying an Incident

The SOP identifies four sources through which cybersecurity incidents may be detected. These sources provide different ways of bringing suspicious activity into the incident response process.

Endpoint agent alerts. Automated alerts from the endpoint agent may identify activity requiring investigation.

Email gateway alerts. The email gateway may identify suspicious or abnormal email-related activity.

User reports. Employees may report activity they believe indicates a cybersecurity incident.

Unusual DMS activity. Abnormal activity involving the branch DMS may trigger incident detection.

Single Point of Accountability

The IT Security Officer is the single point of accountability. This establishes one accountable role for the incident response process rather than distributing overall accountability across multiple departments.

Detection and Confirmation

The containment section begins with the condition of confirmed detection. This distinguishes identifying a possible incident from confirming that the response process should move into containment.

Branch Systems in Scope

The purpose of the SOP specifically covers cybersecurity incidents affecting the branch DMS and email. The listed detection sources support monitoring and reporting around these systems and related endpoints.

2. Containment - Immediate Response

Once an incident has been confirmed, the SOP specifies three containment actions.

Disconnect the affected workstation. The affected workstation is disconnected from the network.

Reset credentials. Credentials associated with the affected situation are reset.

Revoke DMS access. DMS access for the affected user is revoked pending investigation.

Purpose of Containment

The containment stage separates the affected workstation and user access from normal branch activity while the incident is investigated. The SOP specifically links DMS access revocation to the period pending investigation.

Connection to Detection

Containment follows confirmed detection. The process therefore moves from identifying or reporting unusual activity to taking the stated containment actions after confirmation.

Investigation Status

The SOP states that DMS access is revoked pending investigation. This indicates that the containment stage and investigation are connected, while the later eradication and recovery stage describes the technical actions that follow.

3. Eradication and Recovery

After containment, the workstation is re-imaged. Where data loss occurred, backups are restored. A root-cause analysis document is written within seven days.

3. Eradication and Recovery - Restoring Operations

The eradication and recovery stage contains three defined activities.

Workstation re-imaging. The workstation is re-imaged as part of the response process.

Backup restoration. Backups are restored where data loss occurred.

Root-cause analysis. A root-cause analysis document is written within seven days.

Recovery and Data Loss

Backup restoration is conditional in the SOP: it applies where data loss occurred. The procedure therefore distinguishes recovery of lost data from the workstation re-imaging action.

Root-Cause Record

The root-cause analysis document provides a written record of the investigation outcome. The SOP specifies that this document is written within seven days.

4. Communication - Customer Data Breaches

For breaches affecting customer data, HR notifies the customer and the branch manager within 72 hours.

The communication requirement specifically applies to breaches affecting customer data. HR is responsible for the stated notification, and the branch manager is included as a recipient of that notification.

Public Communication

If public communication is required, it is handled by the marketing manager on branch-manager authority only. The SOP therefore separates customer and branch notification from any public communication.

Incident Response Quick Reference

SOP-07 establishes the IT process for responding to cybersecurity incidents affecting the branch DMS and email at Syed Motors.

1. Detection

Detect incidents through endpoint agent alerts, email gateway alerts, user reports, or unusual DMS activity. The IT Security Officer is the single point of accountability.

2. Containment

After confirmed detection, disconnect the affected workstation from the network, reset credentials, and revoke DMS access for the affected user pending investigation.

3. Eradication and Recovery

Re-image the workstation. Restore backups where data loss occurred. Write a root-cause analysis document within seven days.

4. Communication

For breaches affecting customer data, HR notifies the customer and branch manager within 72 hours. Any public communication is handled by the marketing manager on branch-manager authority only.

Process Summary

The response sequence is detection, confirmation, containment, eradication and recovery, followed by the required communication. Detection identifies the incident, containment isolates the affected access and workstation, recovery restores the affected environment, and communication addresses the specified customer-data and public-communication conditions.

Approval and Ownership

This document is owned by the IT department and approved by the Branch Manager. Questions or clarifications should be directed to the document owner. Non-compliance is a disciplinary matter under the HR Policy Manual.

Document Reference

Company: Syed Motors

Document Code: SOP-07

Type: sop

Department: IT

Version: 1.0

Review: Annually by the document owner.